

Say What You Would Do in This Situation

Express Opinion

OREO

Choose & Defend

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Say what you would do in a difficult situation, support it with one reason and one example, and answer a concern about your choice politely.

- WHO** You work in a small company in Johor Bahru. Siti from HR is writing a short guide for new staff called "What would you do?"
- SITUATION** At Thursday's 4 p.m. staff session, Siti reads a case: at the monthly meeting, with eight people in the room, a colleague shows Mr. Tan your idea, a new price list, as his own. You emailed the idea to this colleague on Monday.
- NEED** Siti wants a clear answer from each person: what you would do, and why. Mr. Tan is at the session too, and he has a concern about your answer.
- GOAL** Say what you would do, give one reason and one example, and answer Mr. Tan's concern politely without giving up your view.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Siti asks: "Here's our first case. At the monthly meeting, a colleague shows Mr. Tan your idea as his own. What would you do?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Kumar's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Honestly, I think I would talk to my colleague in private first, not in the meeting. The main reason is that a quiet talk usually fixes the problem. For example, I'd show him my email from Monday with the price list in it. That takes five minutes at his desk, not in front of eight people. So I know some people would go to Mr. Tan straight away, but I'd still talk to him first.

O

OPINION

R

REASON

E

EXAMPLE

O

OPINION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Mei Ling answers a different case: a customer says he paid twice, but he didn't. Order: O → R → E → O.

- ☐ In my view, I would stay calm and check his account with him on the phone.
- ☐ For instance, our record shows one payment of RM450 on 3 June, not two. I'd send him a copy while we talk.
- ☐ This is because an angry customer usually calms down when he sees the facts.
- ☐ That's why I'd check the facts with him first, and not argue.

Write the letter: **O** = Opinion · **R** = Reason · **E** = Example · **O** = Opinion again

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SAY WHAT YOU WOULD DO

☐ I think I would ...

☐ Honestly, I'd ...

☐ I wouldn't ...

☐ I think I'd ...

GIVE A REASON

☐ The main reason is that ...

☐ ..., because ...

☐ ..., so ...

GIVE AN EXAMPLE

☐ For example, ...

☐ If I ..., ...

CONCLUDE

☐ So I think ...

☐ That's why I'd ...

☐ So I'd still ...

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

☐ I see your point, but ...

☐ That's true, but ... /
However, ...

☐ Yes, but I think ...

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I would talk to him first. [**because** / **so** / **but**] A quiet talk usually fixes the problem.

2. He is in my team. [**so** / **because** / **for example,**] I don't want a big argument in the meeting.

3. Some people would tell Mr. Tan straight away. [**but** / **because** / **so**] I'd still talk to him first.

4. A customer shouts at me. [**If ...** / **For example,** / **or**] I keep my voice low.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. I _____ a quiet talk is the better way. (Your opinion now)

☐ thinking

☐ am think

☐ think

2. At the meeting, a colleague _____ Mr. Tan your idea. (The case, told in the present)

☐ showing

☐ show

☐ shows

3. If someone _____ my idea, I talk to them first. (What usually happens)

☐ using

☐ use

☐ uses

4. A quiet talk is _____ than an argument in the meeting. (Comparing two actions)

☐ best

☐ more good

☐ better

SLIDE 09 I'd ... · I wouldn't ... · if

Say what you would do with I'd ... / I wouldn't ... (keep it as a phrase). Use if + present for what usually happens.

I think I'd talk to him in private first.

I wouldn't tell Mr. Tan in front of everyone.

If a customer **shouts**, I keep my voice low.

A quiet talk is **better than** an argument.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O

OPINION

I think I would ...

R

REASON

The main reason is that ...

E

EXAMPLE

For example, I'd ...

O

OPINION AGAIN

I know some people would ..., but I'd still ...

SLIDE 11 Choose & Defend

Choose one of the two actions on your card and say why. Your listener writes your choice, reason and example, then gives one concern. You answer it.

- 1. Round 1 (3:00 each): say your card number and the case in one sentence. Then O → R → E (a fact from your card) → O.
- 2. Listener: fill in the note. A line empty? Ask for it. Then one concern. Speaker: acknowledge, answer in 1–2 sentences.
- 3. Swap roles. Then line B moves one seat. Round 2 (2:00 each): same card, same choice, new partner, shorter.
- 4. Line B moves again. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed: speakers turn the workbook over. Say your choice once more.

Card 1 · A teammate who leaves early

Card 2 · Two dinners, one night

Card 3 · Saturday work or a family trip

Card 4 · A friend’s online business

Listener’s choice note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card + they would ...			
Reason			
Example (day, number)			
Acknowledged? Answered?			

My partner’s question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. What if he says the idea was his too?
2. Won't that make things difficult in your team?
3. Why not wait and see if it happens again?

Start with: **I see your point, but ...** · **That's true. However, I'd still ...** · **Yes, but I think ...**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A neighbour in your condo plays loud music until 1 a.m. on weeknights, and you start work at 9. Would you talk to the neighbour, or tell the management office? Give one reason and one example.

I think I'd ... · **The main reason is that ...** · **For example, ...** · **So I'd still ...**

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

☐

Says clearly what they would do.

☐

Supports the choice with one reason and one example.

☐

Acknowledges a concern or another view and answers it, keeping their choice.

SLIDE 15 Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Clear choice

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Reason + example

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Answering a concern

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Useful expressions

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Confidence

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11 Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · A teammate who leaves early

Ask: "What's the problem with your teammate, and what would you do?" Fill in the note. Then one concern, yours or: "But what if she is upset with you?" / "But what if nothing changes?"

Card 2 · Two dinners, one night

Ask: "Which dinner would you go to?" Fill in the note. Then one concern, yours or: "But what if the others are unhappy?" / "But what if you feel sorry later?"

Card 3 · Saturday work or a family trip

Ask: "What's the problem with Saturday, and what would you do?" Fill in the note. Then one concern, yours or: "But what if your boss is not happy?" / "But what if your family is upset?"

Card 4 · A friend's online business

Ask: "What does your friend want, and what would you do?" Fill in the note. Then one concern, yours or: "But what if your friend is upset?" / "But what if you lose money?"

SLIDE 11 **Speaker cards: fold or cut**

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · A teammate who leaves early

Choose: talk to her, or tell Mr. Tan. · Her son's daycare closes at 5.30. · You take her customer calls until 6: about 8 calls a week. · Your teammate leaves at 5 p.m. three days a week. · She has never asked you.

Card 2 · Two dinners, one night

Choose: annual dinner or wedding. · The wedding is in Melaka, three hours' drive. · Both are on Saturday 12 December, 7.30 p.m. · The bride was at school with you for 11 years. · Your team gets an award at the annual dinner.

Card 3 · Saturday work or a family trip

Choose: work on Saturday or keep your plan. · Two colleagues already said yes. · You booked a family trip to Desaru this Saturday. · The hotel (RM280) gives no refund. · Mr. Tan needs people to pack 500 boxes for Monday.

Card 4 · A friend's online business

Choose: join, or say no. · It costs RM300 to start. · Two friends joined last year and stopped after three months. · A good friend sells health drinks online and wants you in her team. · She says you can earn RM1,000 a month.